Gradient Editing

Release version 1.0 (2007-11-09)

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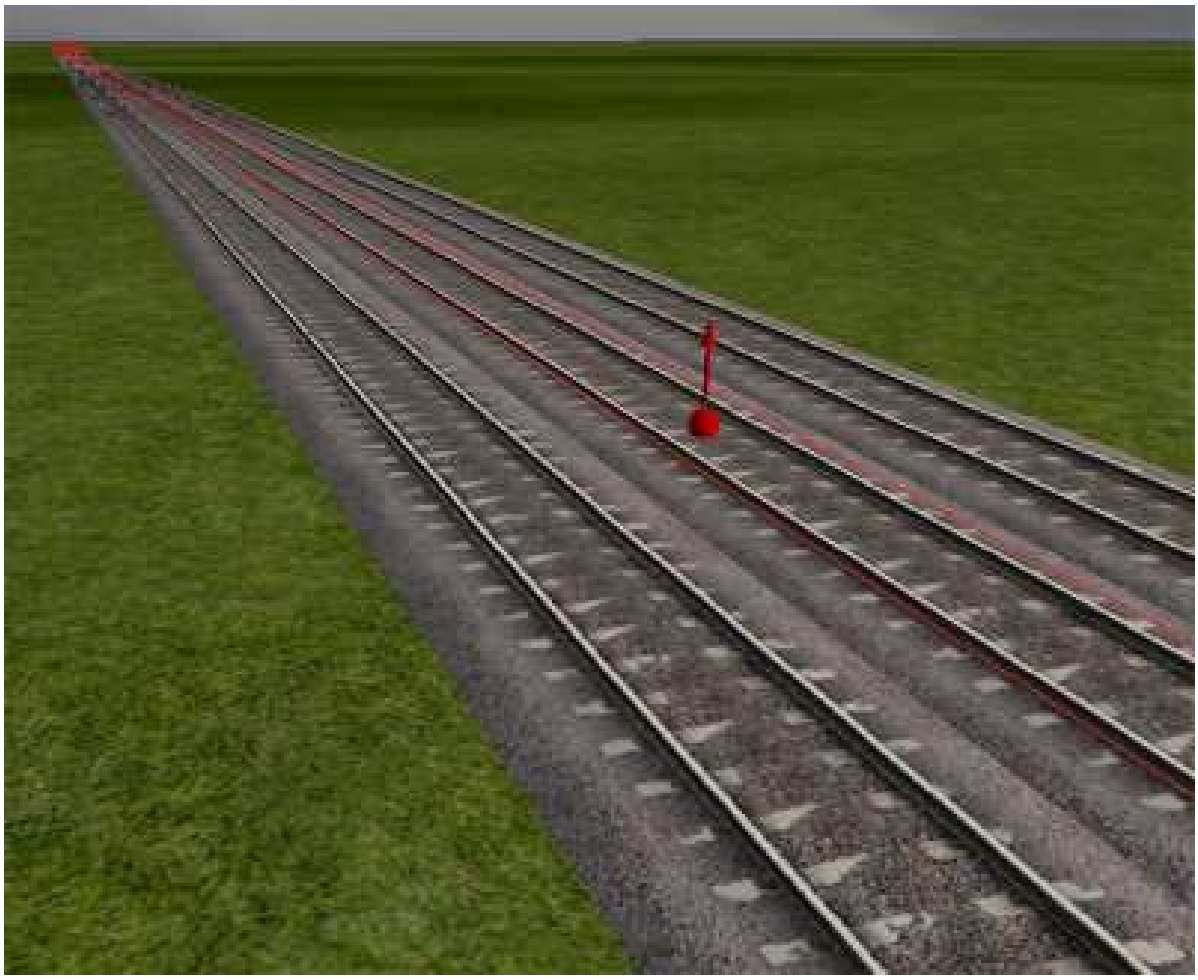
1 Laid Track

3 tracks have been laid at 500m long, but the gradient is wrong!

Select the Gradient Tool in the top left tool window, and clicked on the middle 500m long track section.



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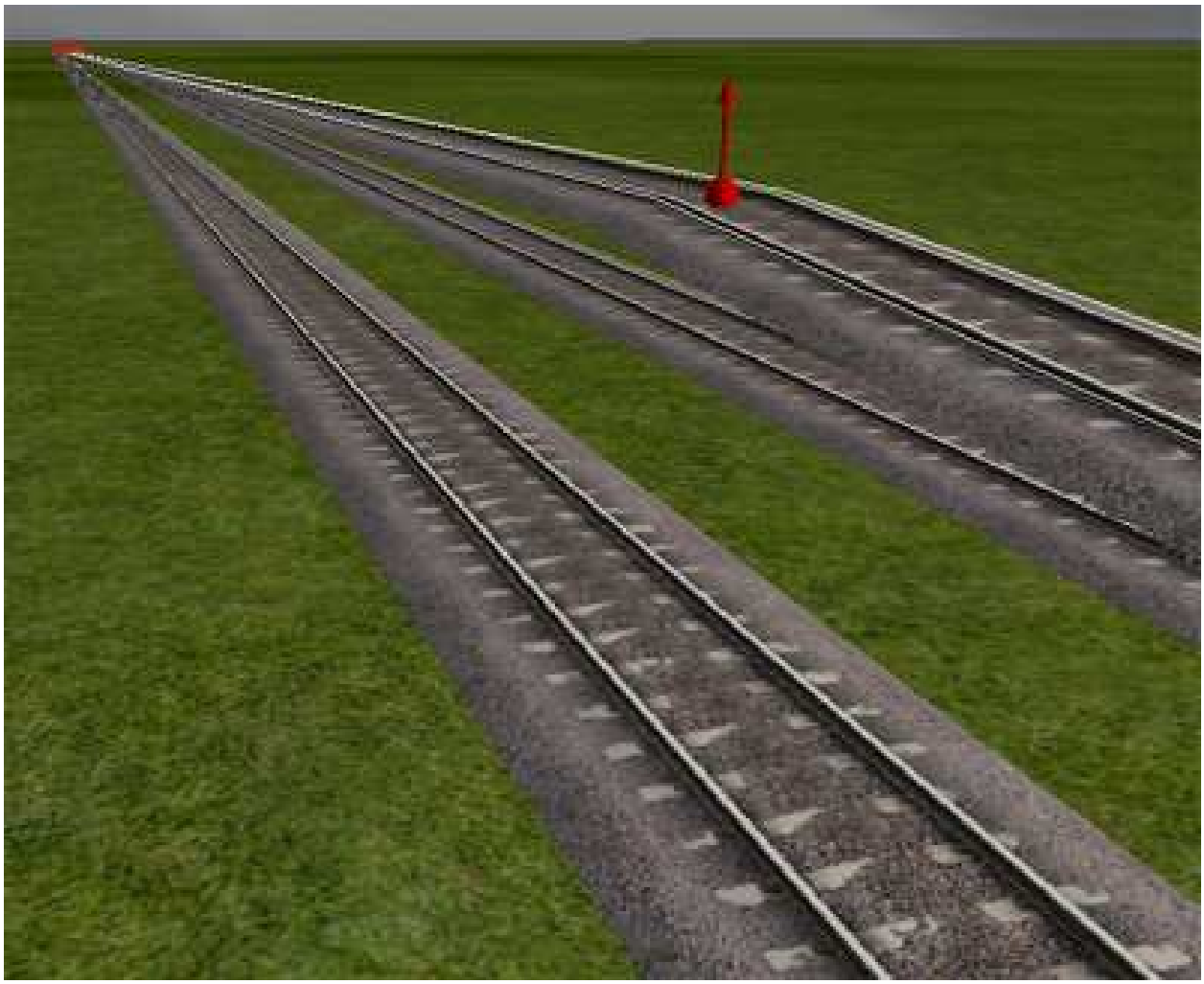
2 Changing the Gradient – Method 1

Pull the track up with the gradient tool and it will use the ends of the 500m length as the hinge points. So the entire section is altered in one shallow gradient. This is the case even when the line consists of multiple track pieces. The hinge point will be at the END of the track, not just the piece you have clicked on.



This illustrates that gradients can be altered in the middle of track pieces, as well as ends, but it is the WRONG method to use when editing gradients AFTER track has been laid.

This method has some adverse effects such as several miles of track being moved above or below terrain, even with the smallest change in gradient. Such an event may result in the entire section requiring replacement.

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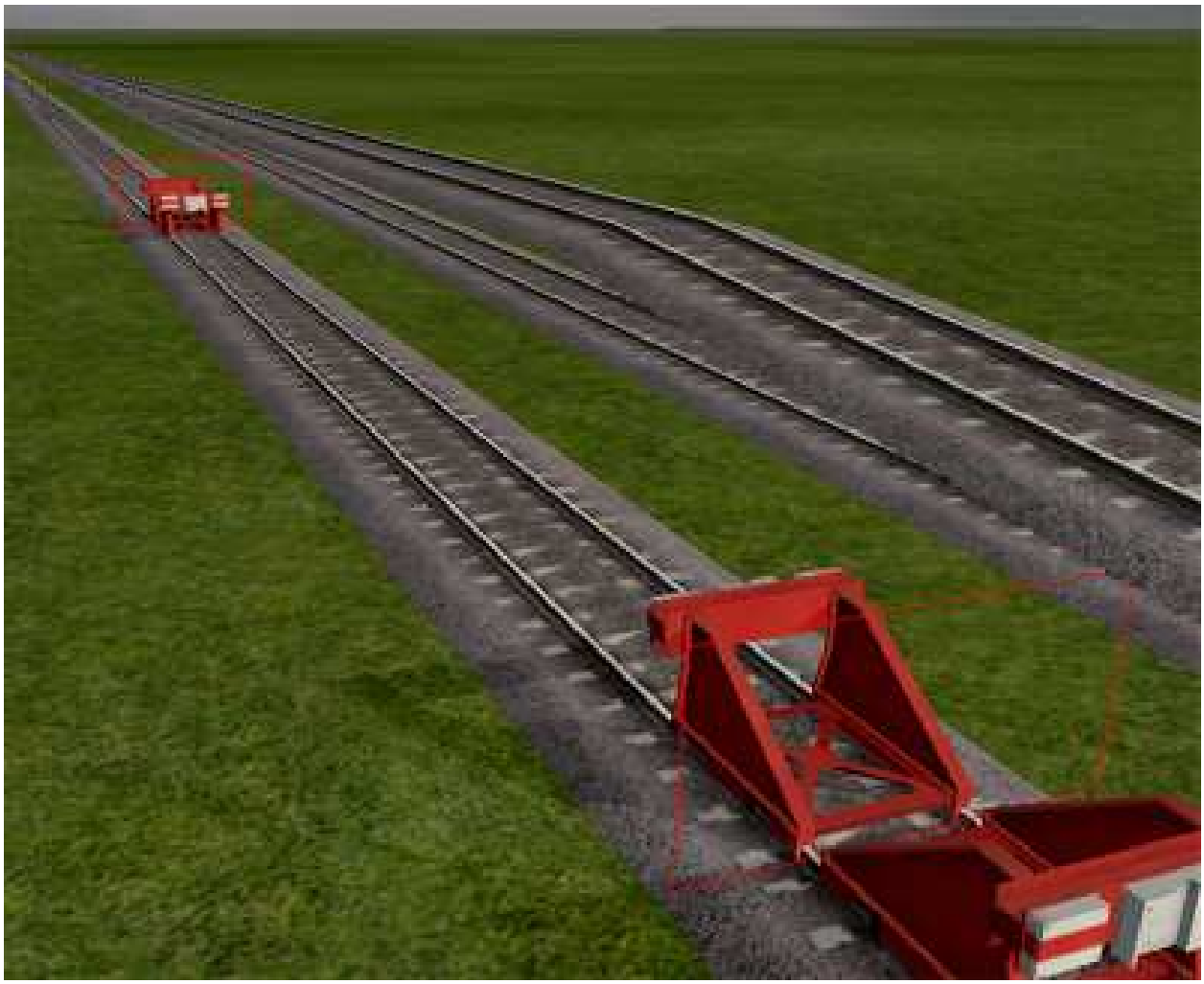
3 Changing the Gradient – Method 2

To avoid editing the gradient on huge amounts of track, when you know the limits of the gradient change are within a small distance, or for a specific track, you can use the 'Split' tool to define the limitations of what you want to alter.

So this time, we use the Split tool to mark a small 50m section of the 500m track, effectively creating 3 pieces of track from the original 1 *[1x400m 2x50m in this case].*



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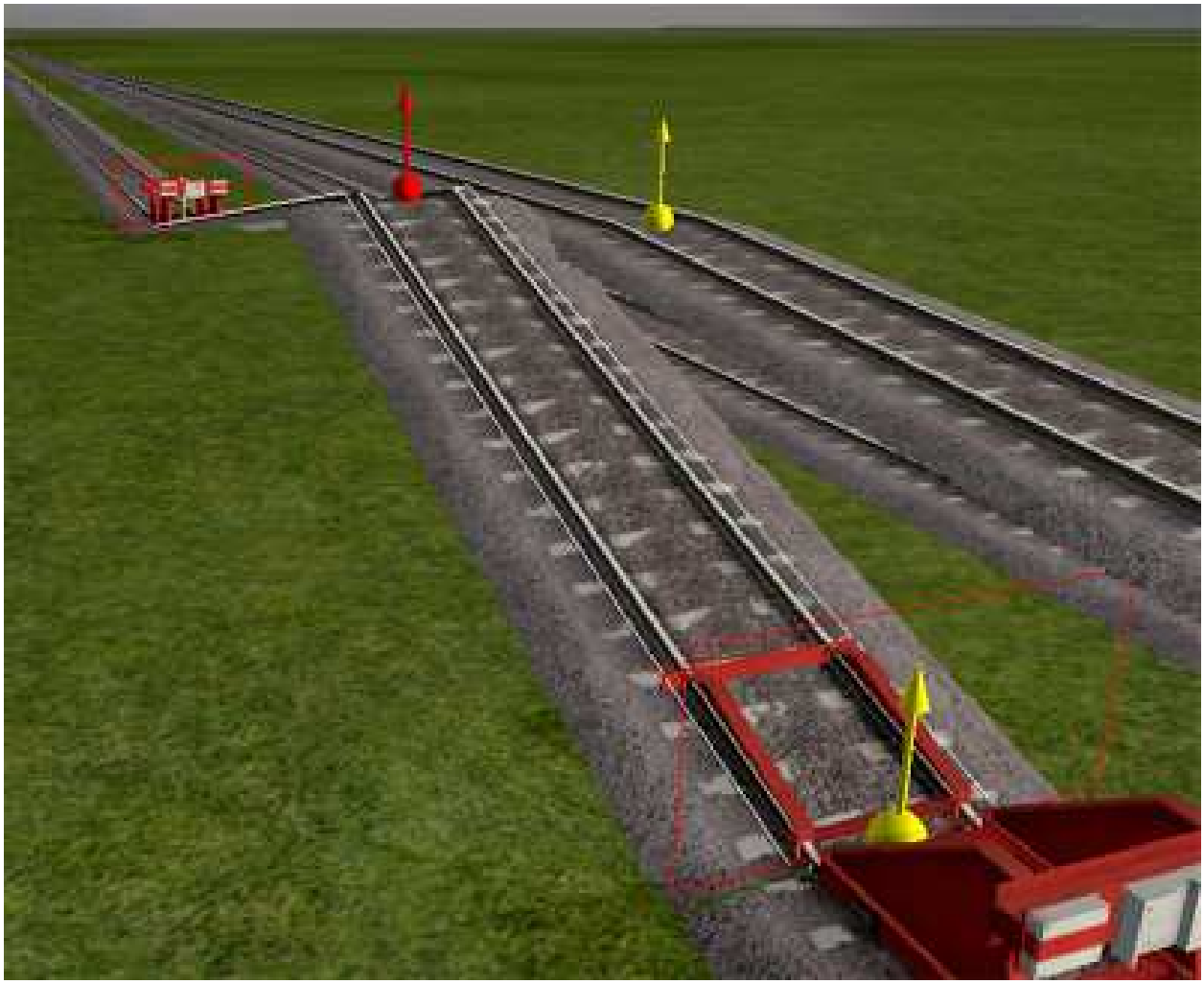
4 Defined Gradient Editing

Now, the game sees the ends of the track at either end of where we want to make our gradient change, rather than end of our entire track network. Making the editing much more controllable and much less destructive if it goes wrong.

Reselect the Gradient tool, and click on the section to be altered. From the picture you can see once again I have clicked on the middle of the piece rather than one end, so segmented track is not required in order to alter gradients in Rail Simulator.



Dragging the track up and my gradient change is confined between the two splits we put into the track.

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5 Closing the Gap

Once we have made the required change, all that's needed is to weld the two splits that were made. As these splits created track ends, and the gradient changes hinge from track ends, we are safe in the knowledge that the split track still matches up perfectly and there will be no harsh jumps in track or painful realigning getting them to meet up again.

Select the weld tool, and click on the joining boxes above the split ends:

Gradient change, less track pieces required (4 differently graded straights, but only 3 pieces of track), and nothing else on the network affected.

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